

Apple's reigniting growth

And it's focusing on electric cars, medical devices and not just wearable electronics to recapture the world's imagination dgit.in/1oHLPvN

**WP8 to run Android apps**

Some sources suggest that Microsoft is considering integrating Android apps on its Windows and WP8 platforms.

In conversation with Adobe

We spent an afternoon chatting up with Adobe's Paul Burnett and Karl Soule, both distinguished creative professionals in their own right, to try and understand Adobe's take on 3D printing, Exclusive excerpts from our interview:

Jayesh Shinde

jayesh.sbinde@thinkdigit.com

Adobe Photoshop is traditionally recognized as an advanced 2D design software. How do you see it adapting to the disruptive phenomenon of 3D printing?

Paul: So, a few years ago we added 3D to Photoshop and have improved upon it since then, and the reason we did that because there wasn't any tool in the market that enabled 3D artists to easily work on the textures of 3D objects. Most of the apps like Studio, Maxx, etc, allowed you to output a texture mesh but it's really difficult to paint on them. Photoshop gave those people a way to bring those models in and work visually on the textures almost as if they were picking up a 3D model with a paintbrush and painting on it. That really attracted a lot of people who worked with 3D.

So yeah, you can build simple 3D stuff, but I wouldn't build anything complex in Photoshop, instead I'll use the 3D tools out there to do some manipulation and enhancement of the 3D models. As soon as we added 3D support in Photoshop, we found people were using 3D models in their compositions.

Also, people always think of Photoshop to be this photo manipulation tool, but it also has video editing capabilities. Bringing video, audio, and 2D PSD compositions is a big part of Photoshop as well. And the beauty of it is that I can bring all the power of Photoshop still editing (layer effects, blend modes, etc) into my videos in Photoshop. So really it's a much bigger tool than just used for photo manipulation – it's also for 3D.

Karl: We hear a lot of people say that they only use 20 per cent of Photoshop and one of the key things about it is that the 20 per cent you use may be different from 20



Adobe's Karl Soule (L) and Paul Burnett (R) showing off 3D printed objects.

per cent I use or 20 per cent that someone uses. It's clearly one of those things that anybody who's creative has a copy of on their desktop. It's a one-stop shop for a lot of things. It's amazing how it's evolved over the years and how it's continuing to grow in the whole 3D printing space.

With the consumerization of 3D printing, how do you see Photoshop (or other Adobe products) giving creative professionals the power to do?

Paul: Obviously, there's a huge emerging interest in 3D printers. As the technology becomes better, the cost comes down and they become more accessible to the general public. They want a way to be able to easily create their own content, whether it's buying their own 3D printer or whether it's doing it through someone like Shapeways.com. The ability to print something in 3D is simply pretty cool. And for a variety of reasons people want to be able to do that. We saw that there was a real gap from tooling to simplifying the process. So just grabbing a 3D model and often a lot of 3D software

is quite complex for people to get into. So giving people the ability to use models for manipulating very simply, giving them an interface to manipulate textures and compositing different elements together is important – and Photoshop does all that. It's a tool they're all already used to and it gives them the ability to create and enhance those 3D elements, and then just simply print it – whether it's a local 3D printer or an online one. And the response from the industry to this Photoshop feature has been phenomenal.

Karl: I really think this is going to be one of those pivotal moments how desktop publishing or digital video was, where you kind of look back on the old way of doing things and in the long run having a common platform to make sure things will be able to print properly, to have the ease of use that Photoshop's providing is going to be a big deal moving forward.

To read the entire interview, head over to this link: <http://dgit.in/AdobePaulDgt>